SOC Simulator Investigation: Phishing Email

Alert ID: 8815
Email received (UTC): 2026-11-02 01:42:54
Alert time (UTC): 2026-11-02 01:44
Affected user: h.harris@thetrydaily[.]thm (Hannah Harris)
Alert type: Phishing
Severity: Medium
Verdict: True Positive
Disposition: Closed, True Positive

Summary

On November 2, 2026, an inbound email to h.harris@thetrydaily[.]thm was flagged by email security for containing a suspicious external link. The email, from urgents@amazon[.]biz, impersonated “Amazon Delivery” with a fake failed-delivery notice and urged the user to click a shortened link. After further investigation, it was confirmed as phishing (True Positive), and the alert was closed.

Evidence

Email details

- **Received:** 2026-11-02 01:42:54 UTC by **h.harris@thetrydaily[.]thm**
- **Sender**: urgents@amazon[.]biz
- **Subject**: “Your Amazon Package Couldn’t Be Delivered - Action Required”
- The body claims a failed delivery due to an incomplete address, addresses the recipient as “Dear Customer,” and asks them to confirm shipping information via a link within 48 hours
- **Link**: hxxp://bit[.]ly/3sHkX3da12340 (URL shortener, unencrypted HTTP)
- **Attachment**: none

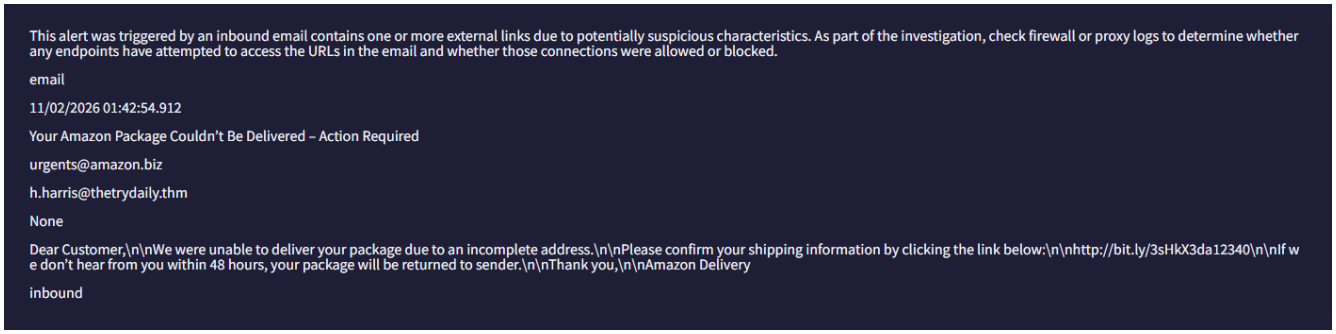


Figure 1: Alert on SOC Simulator with email details

Sender reputation

- amazon[.]biz returned no malicious detection in TryDetectThis (TryHackMe's local version of VirusTotal)

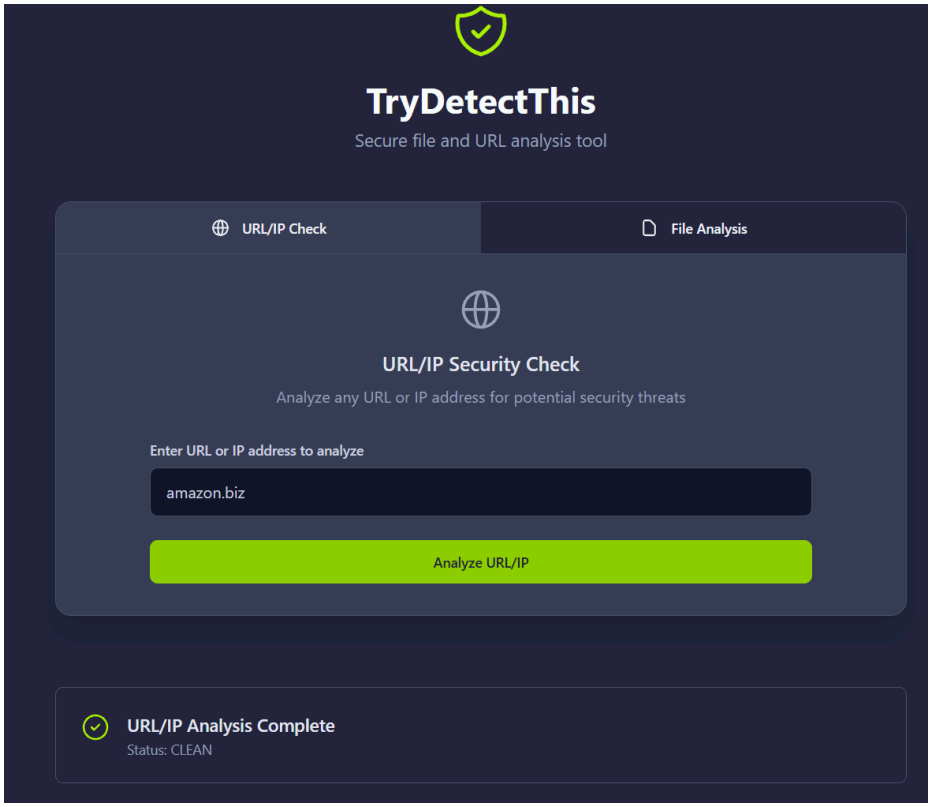


Figure 2: URL analysis of amazon[.]biz

URL and IP analysis

- The link was analyzed in TryDetectThis and returned Malicious
- The destination IP 67[.]199[.]248[.]11 also returned Malicious; this address belongs to Bitly's shortener infrastructure
- The URL was not opened, and the redirect destination was not observed

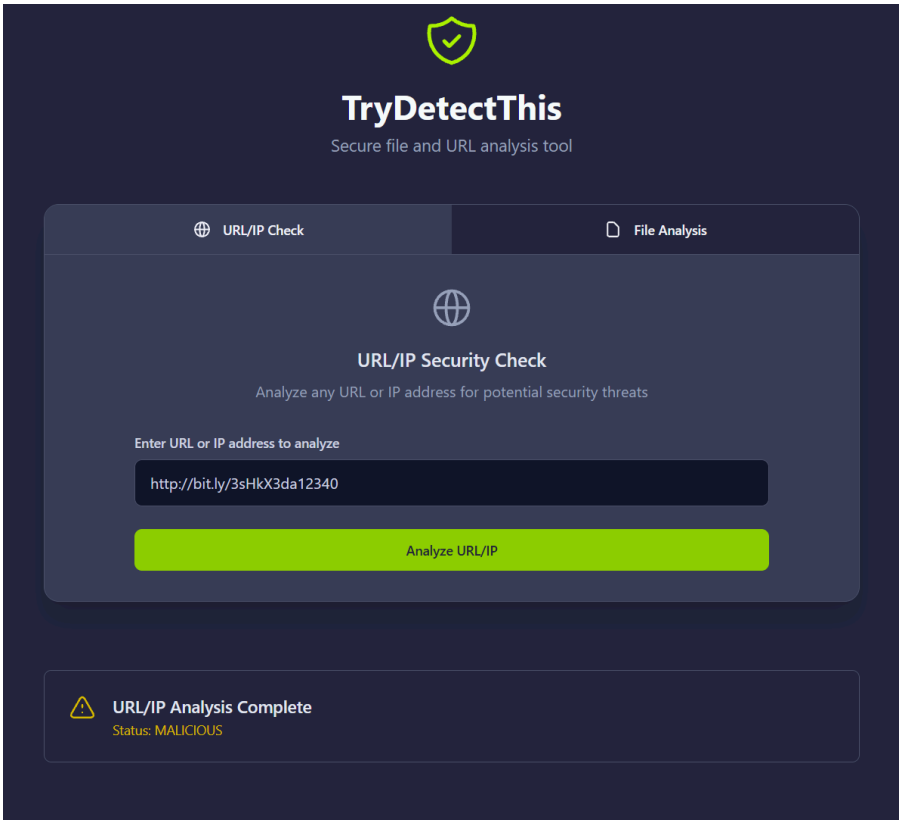


Figure 3: URL analysis of bit[.]ly shortened link

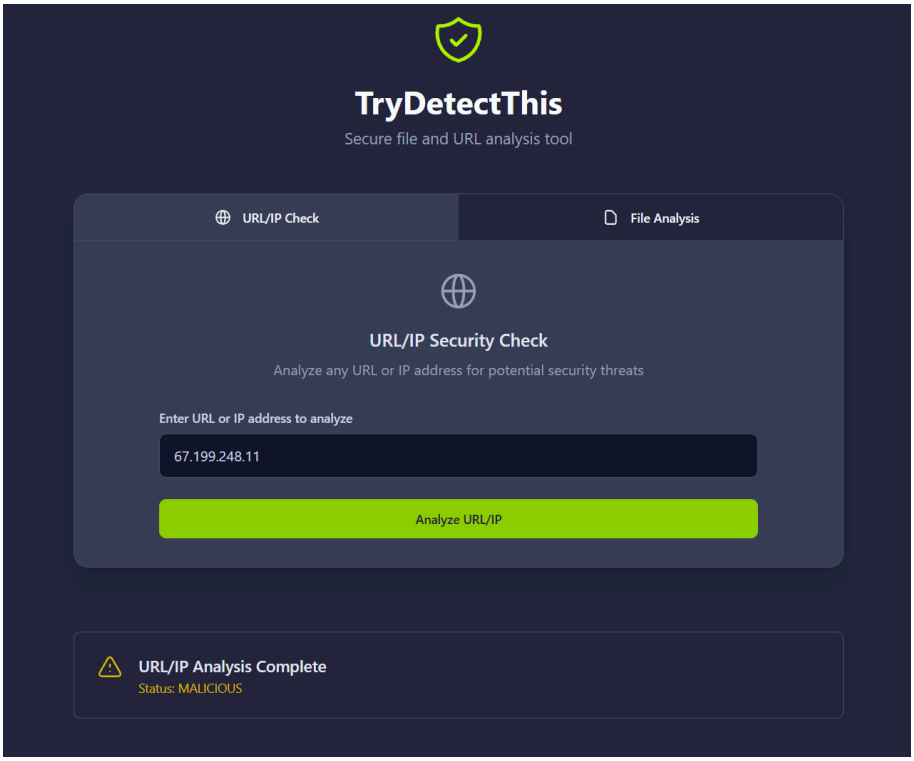


Figure 4: IP analysis of bit[.]ly shortened link

Firewall activity

- 01:44:08 UTC: a web request from internal host 10.20.2.17 (source port 34257) to hxxp://bit[.]ly/3sHkX3da12340 (destination 67[.]199[.]248[.]11, port 80/TCP) was blocked under the “Blocked Websites” rule
- This was 1 minute 14 seconds after the email was delivered

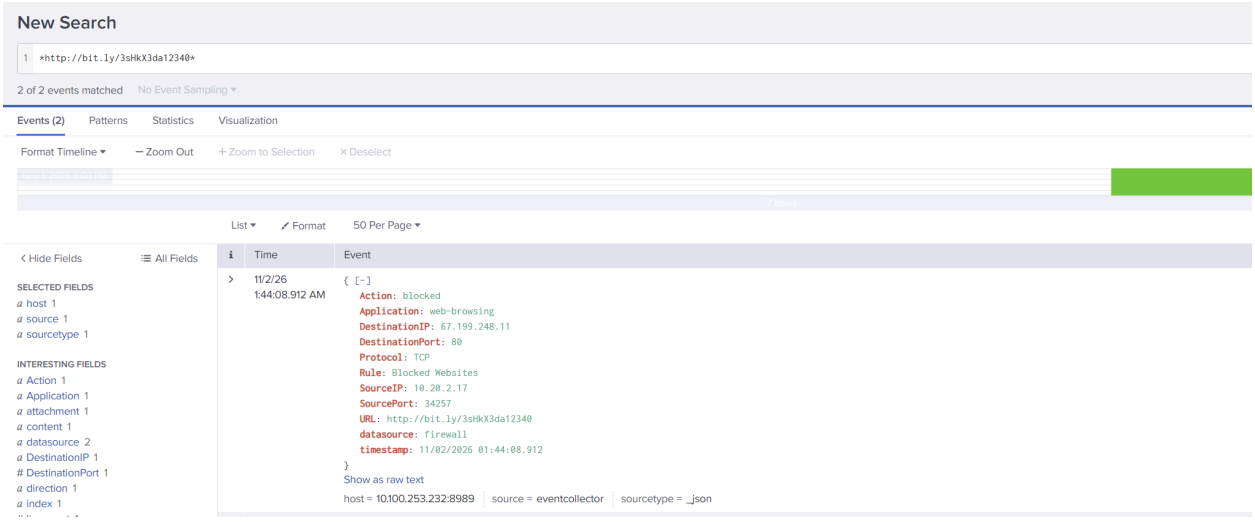


Figure 5: Splunk log of firewall blocking the malicious website

Scope

- A search for the URL in Splunk did not result in additional hosts accessing it
- No further suspicious activity was observed from 10.20.2.17 after the block in the logs reviewed

Timeline

Time (UTC)	Event	Source
2026-11-02 01:42:54	Phishing email delivered to h.harris@thetrydaily[.]thm	Email security
2026-11-02 01:44:08	Request from 10.20.2.17 to the shortened URL blocked	Firewall

IOCs

Type	Value	Context
Sender email	urgents@amazon[.]biz	Impersonates Amazon; domain does not match Amazon's primary domain
Sender domain	amazon[.]biz	No malicious detection in reputation check; assessed as a lookalike
URL	hxxp://bit[.]ly/3sHkX3da12340	Flagged as malicious (TryDetectThis); request blocked by firewall
IP	67[.]199[.]248[.]11	Bitly shortener IP (shared infrastructure), flagged as malicious (TryDetectThis)

Assessment

The email is assessed as a phishing True Positive. It impersonates an Amazon delivery notice and gives the recipient a short amount of time (48 hrs) to act, which creates artificial urgency, a common social engineering tactic used by malicious actors. The domain amazon[.]biz is not Amazon's primary domain, but it was also not flagged by TryDetectThis, which could mean that the domain is fairly new. The shortened bit[.]ly link was flagged as malicious in TryDetectThis. A request from internal host 10.20.2.17 to the link was blocked by the firewall 74 seconds after delivery; the connection was not completed, and the final destination was not reached. No other hosts accessed the URL in the logs reviewed, and no further suspicious activity was observed from 10.20.2.17.

Actions Taken / Recommended

Taken:

- Documented findings in the case report
- Marked alert as True Positive
- Closed alert

Recommended:

- Block sender urgents@amazon[.]biz and the malicious URL hxxp://bit[.]ly/3sHkX3da12340 at the email gateway and web filter
- Purge the email from the recipient's mailbox
- Notify h.harris and remind them how to report suspicious emails